

further away from the dealership. Phil consoled himself with the sense of “power” he now felt in his hot new car.

Phil put the extra expense out of his mind by concentrating on the beautiful women he was sure that his new car would attract. He imagined meeting the woman of his dreams and living happily ever after. But before Phil had the opportunity to meet this woman of his dreams, his car was repossessed.

Ironically, as Phil was forced to take the bus to work, he met a woman seated next to him one morning. They started talking and ended up making plans to meet for coffee. One thing led to another and Phil is now happily in a relationship with this woman. Phil learned an expensive lesson: “Not everyone judges you by what you drive.”

Phil had attempted to use money to bolster his self-esteem. Using money for power can have a darker side, including blackmail and bribery. But using money as any form of control, whether you want to control someone’s impression of you or his or her vote in Congress, is likely to lead to a result you will regret. If you relate to money as a source of “power,” you will want to avoid this extreme behavior.

Security: Save for a Rainy Day

For some people, money is a source of security. Therefore, they are very careful to maintain a source of savings. Saving is always smart, but should not be taken to the extreme. Neglecting to also spend or share (the other two uses of money) will create an imbalance. If all of your money is diverted to your savings accounts, you may end up being labeled a “penny pincher” or a “tightwad.” Are you so against spending money that you would rather live a miserly existence?

The need to feel secure is normal. Spending money wisely will help to achieve this sense of security. However, some people

